Yihao Xu

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Research Profile

- Computational design science researcher working on multimodal learning and predictive analytics for digital platforms, with additional work in computational measurement of organizational culture.
- First author of a paper at the *International Conference on Information Systems* (2025) and an article in *IEEE Sensors Journal*; the ICIS paper was a Best Complete Paper Nominee / Best-in-Track Paper.
- Experience designing multimodal and multi-view learning models, modeling temporal distribution shift, and assessing organizational culture from text; Python, PyTorch, and SQL.
- Teaching assistant across two fall terms; coordinated six study sessions involving 60 participants who are deaf or hard of hearing in an AR accessibility study.

Education

M.S. in Management Science and Engineering **Expected 2027**
School of Management, University of Science and Technology of China (USTC) *Hefei, China*
Advisor: Prof. Hefu Liu.

B.M. in Information Management and Information Systems **2024**
School of Management, Hefei University of Technology (HFUT) *Hefei, China*

Research Interests

Topics: Digital platforms and crowdfunding · Cultural and creative markets · Organizational culture · Accessible human–AI interaction
Methods: Multimodal representation learning · Multi-view deep clustering · Temporal generalization · Computational text measurement

Published Research

1. Subtly There, Deeply Felt: Modeling Cultural Values in Crowdfunding Success Prediction
Yihao Xu, Wenxiang Zhao, and Xiaoyu Yao.
46th International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), Sharing Economy, Platforms, and Crowds Track, Nashville, TN, 2025. *ICIS 2025 Best Complete Paper Nominee / Best-in-Track Paper.*

- Creative projects convey cultural meaning through text, images, and metadata. This study models those values and examines their roles in crowdfunding success.
- The Cultural Value-based Prediction Model (CV-PM) organizes content features around Throsby's six cultural values. Value-specific convolutional layers refine noisy features, and attention learns their joint predictive contributions.
- On 14,539 Kickstarter projects, AUC reached 94.72% in Art and 95.14% in Design, exceeding the strongest respective baselines by 1.49 and 3.65 percentage points.
- Value ablations showed the largest accuracy losses for social value in Art (7.17 percentage points) and aesthetic value in Design (5.19), revealing category differences in their predictive roles.

2. Multisensor Deep Clustering Networks With Joint Learning Strategy for Fault Diagnosis Considering Consensus-Specific Constraint
Yihao Xu, Mingfeng Lu, Gang Wang, and Fang Fang.
IEEE Sensors Journal, 25(11), 19921–19936, 2025. doi:10.1109/JSEN.2025.3560460.

- Unsupervised fault diagnosis faces two problems: separately learned features may not suit clustering, and multiple sensors contain shared as well as sensor-specific signals.
- MsDCN combines a sensor-aware attentive encoder for shared patterns with sensor-specific encoders. A consensus-specific constraint balances these representations during joint optimization of reconstruction and clustering.
- Across 20 runs per dataset, MsDCN achieved the highest mean clustering accuracy on six gearbox and bearing datasets. Gains over the strongest comparison method were 5.74–11.35 percentage points on the two DIRG bearing datasets; ablations examined the sensor-attention and consensus-specific designs.

Work in Progress

3. Multimodal Learning under Evolving Environments for Crowdfunding Outcome Prediction

Yihao Xu, Wenxiang Zhao, and Hefu Liu. *Planned submission to Information Systems Research in 2026.*

- Develops multimodal representations for pre-launch crowdfunding prediction and adapts the use of campaign content as its relationship with funding outcomes changes over time.

4. From Anchor to Evidence: A Theory-Driven Model for Newly Launched Crowdfunding Success Prediction

Wenxiang Zhao, **Yihao Xu**, and Xiaoyu Yao. *Working Paper.*

- Models the distinct roles of project summaries and detailed information in pre-launch crowdfunding prediction, drawing on anchoring-and-adjustment theory.

5. Interfirm Cultural Matching and Supply Chains

Research in progress.

- Develops an LLM-based method to assess cultural matching between firms and explores its relationship with supply chains.

6. AI Assistants and Customer Satisfaction in Digital Service Platforms

Early-stage Research Project.

- Proposed analysis of the association between conversational behavior and user satisfaction in Meituan customer–AI assistant dialogues.

Conference Presentation

Yihao Xu, Wenxiang Zhao, and Xiaoyu Yao. *Subtly There, Deeply Felt: Modeling Cultural Values in Crowdfunding Success Prediction.* 46th International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), Sharing Economy, Platforms, and Crowds Track, Nashville, TN, Dec. 2025.

Research and Teaching Experience

Research Assistant, University of Science and Technology of China *Jun. 2026–Present*

Supported an AR smart-glasses study on communication access and social inclusion for people who are deaf or hard of hearing; coordinated materials, participant arrangements, device setup, and six study sessions involving 60 participants.

Teaching Assistant, University of Science and Technology of China *Fall 2025, 2026*

Information Technology and Organizational Strategy 42 students; 40 hours

Instructor: Prof. Juan Qin; coordinated assignments, group activities, and feedback.

Awards and Scholarships

Awards

- Outstanding Graduate of Anhui Province (top 3% students) 2024
- Outstanding Student Award (top 10% students) 2023

Scholarships

- China National Scholarship 2025
- First-Class Graduate Scholarship, USTC 2025, 2026
- Shishengqing Scholarship, School of Management, HFUT 2024
- Academic Progress Scholarship, School of Management, HFUT 2022
- First-Class Scholarship, HFUT (top 3% students) 2021

Internships

Research Intern *Jun.–Aug. 2026*

USTC Yangtze River Delta Science and Technology Strategic Frontier Research Center

Conducted desk research, case analysis, and comparative studies of firms' early development and commercialization in commercial spaceflight, AI, and semiconductors.

Technical Service Intern, CEO Office, Volkswagen (Anhui) Automotive Co., Ltd. *Apr.–Jul. 2024*

Hefei, China. Built and maintained an automotive after-sales database for recurring service reporting and operational analysis.

Computational Skills and Languages

Computational Methods: Multimodal learning · Multi-view deep clustering · Attention mechanisms · Temporal generalization · Sentence embeddings and semantic retrieval

Programming: Python · PyTorch · SQL · Stata

Languages: Chinese (native) · English (IELTS Academic 7.5)